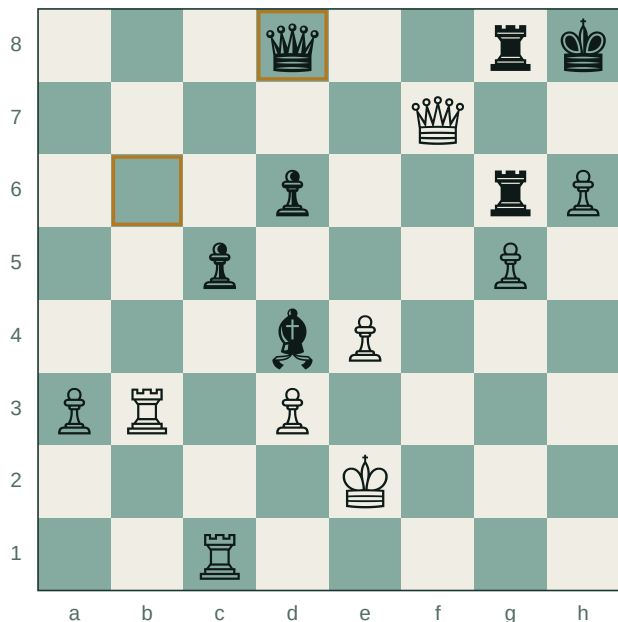


Quiet tactical moves: White, move 37

Quiet tactical moves

White to move



Previous move: 36...Qd8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

37. Rb7 Rxh6 38. gxh6 Rg2+ 39. Kd1 Qg8 40. Qxg8+

37.Rb7 The rook moves from b3 to b7. Recorded reply: **37...Rxh6**.

38.gxh6 The pawn captures the rook on h6. Recorded reply: **38...Rg2+**.

39.Kd1 The king moves from e2 to d1. Recorded reply: **39...Qg8**.

40.Qxg8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From g8 it attacks king on h8 and rook on g2.

At the end, nominal material is White 23 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +13. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +13:** the balance goes from +0 to +13. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on h8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.